Week 32
August 3, 2026

Expana

Global Weekly Industrial and Macroeconomic Insight

METALS	EXPANA SERIES	CURRENT	PREVIOUS	WOW	WOW%
Copper 3m LME	LN06	$13,800/MT	$13,617/MT	+$183	+1.3%
ENERGY		CURRENT	PREVIOUS	WOW	WOW%
Crude oil Brent ICE EU (DH-0)	BCRD	$90.12/barrel	$96.78/barrel	-$6.66	-6.9%
Natural gas TTF NL (DH-0)	NGNL	€59.04/MWH	€63.76/MWH	-€4.72	-7.4%
Natural gas NYMEX US (DH-0)*	NGAS	$2.75/10Therm	$2.87/10Therm	-$0.12	-4.2%
Electricity base year EEX DE (DH-0)	ED50	€104.24/MWH	€111.40/MWH	-€7.16	-6.4%
CURRENCY		CURRENT	PREVIOUS	WOW	WOW%
USD Index	N/A	101.37	101.21	+0.16	+0.16%

Current daily prices as of July 31, 2026. Previous daily prices as of July 24, 2026. All charts are sourced from Expana unless otherwise stated.

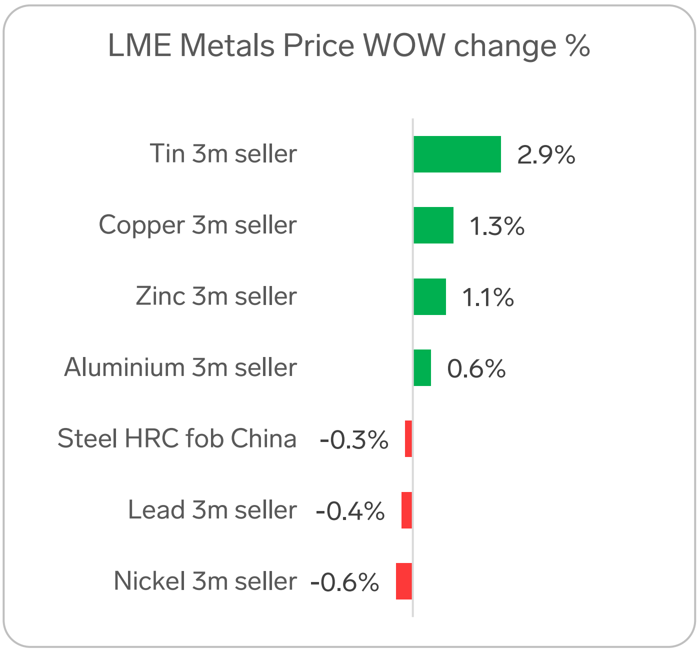
Key Points

- Base metal prices were mostly on the rise, particularly those of metals used in electronics manufacturing.
- Shipping rates maintain downward trend, amid softening demand.
- Energy prices fell notably throughout the week, driven by greater supply optimism following the pause in fighting between the US and Iran.

Metals

The last week of July brought price increases for most base metals on the LME. Tin and copper posted the largest gains, as higher raw material prices drove production costs up while the electronics sector expanded actively, supporting strong demand for these metals. US manufacturers' new orders for computers and electronics in June posted record 17% year over year (YOY) growth. This growth is reflected in global markets, with Taiwan's export orders for electronics and components to the US growing nearly 84% YOY in June. Zinc price increases were also driven by high raw material prices, as suppliers cannot scale production fast enough, creating shortages particularly in China. However, Asian sources noted low export margins are constraining refined zinc production growth.

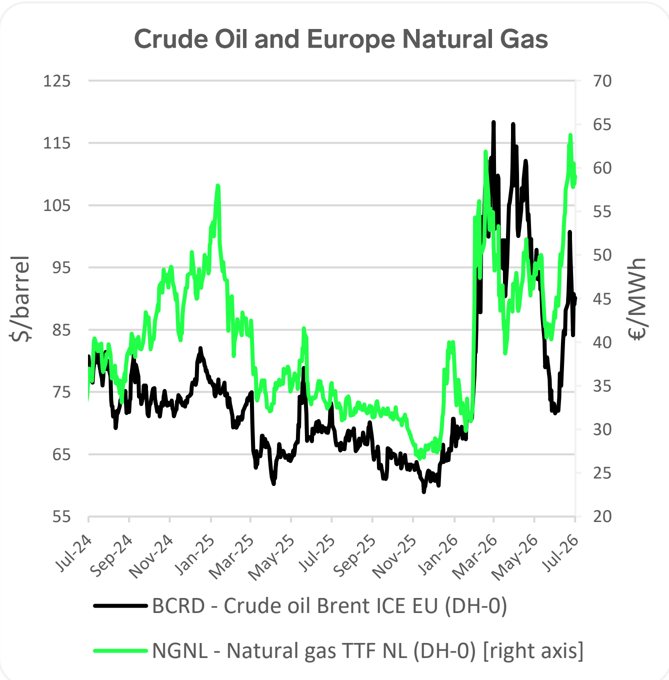
Steel hot-rolled coil (HRC) prices moved in different directions globally. Chinese demand fell, driving domestic prices down 2% week over week (WOW) and also pressuring export prices lower. US market prices continued rising despite sources noting that importers are becoming increasingly interested despite tariffs. In Europe, with steel import restrictions effective from July, domestic steel demand remains elevated as producers maintain high order levels, supporting upward price pressure despite the start of vacation season.



Energy

Brent crude prices fell 6.9% WOW to $90.12 per barrel, attributable to greater optimism over a longer-term peace resolution to the Middle East conflict. Throughout the week, the US and Iran paused strikes on one another's territory or military personnel, with sources reporting that diplomatic developments were progressing with the help of Oman as a mediator. Players in the crude oil market therefore interpreted the week's geopolitical action as a clue about a possible increase of crude oil being shipped out of the Persian Gulf and into global markets.

European natural gas TTF prices decreased 7.4% WOW to €59.04/MWh. Although prices remain elevated, players in Europe's natural gas markets noted the market was characterized by "cautious optimism" throughout the week, driven by the pause in fighting between the US and Iran. Like the crude oil market, players became slightly more confident about the prospect of LNG flows resuming out of the Strait of Hormuz.

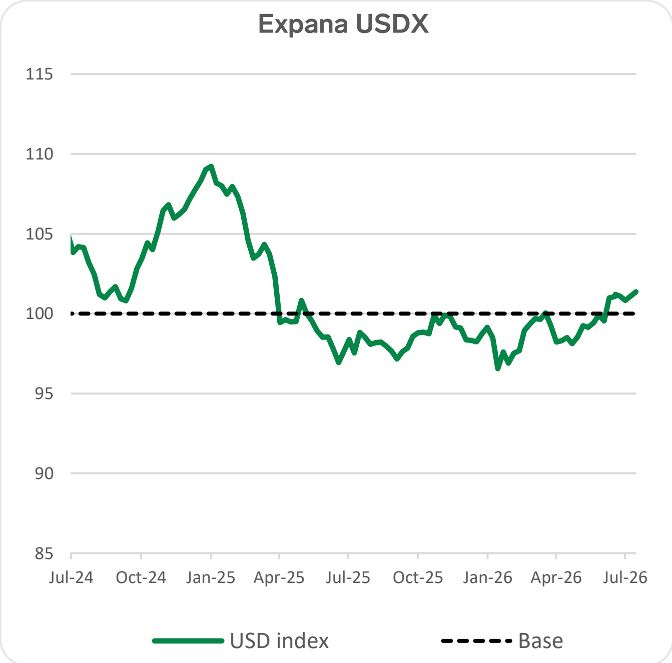


Shipping

The Global Shipping 40-foot Container Composite Index decreased by 2.7% WOW in the last week of July, to $4,255/unit. Prices increased significantly in June and the start of July, as heavy frontloading initiated an earlier-than-expected start to peak season. However, demand started weakening later in the month, with market sources suggesting that frontloading is easing. While sources suggest that an increase in capacity, particularly to the US West Coast, likely contributed to an easing of rates, others note that carriers are now actively managing capacity in an effort to prevent further rate decreases. With tensions in the Gulf ongoing, oil prices have continued to fluctuate, and carriers are reportedly planning additional emergency fuel surcharges for August. In addition, market players suggest that additional US tariffs may be implemented later this year, a potential watch-out factor. Market sources expect rates to remain steady in the short term.

Macroeconomics

USDX



Expana's US Dollar Index (USDX) was 101.37, up 0.16% WOW. Safe-haven demand due to the ongoing Middle East conflict continues to support the USDX, despite the pause in fighting throughout the week. Furthermore, some sources still anticipate interest rate hikes in 2026, adding further upward momentum to the USDX.